QINGJUAN PRACTICE

Practice 01

Academic · paper view

What is inside

Listening · 4 sections, 40 questions, about 12 minutes

Reading · 3 passages, 40 questions

Writing · Task 1 chart and Task 2 essay

Original practice material written for this desk.

Not an official IELTS test. Not affiliated with Cambridge, the British Council, IDP, or the IELTS partners. Do not treat the fictional towns, figures, or figures in the charts as reported fact.

Listening

Section 1 · Questions 1·10

Complete the form below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

1. Surname: _____

2. Mobile: _____

3. Workshop: _____

4. Start date: _____

5. Fee: £ _____

6. Fee includes: _____

7. Student must bring: _____

8. Room: Studio _____

9. Tutor: Ms _____

10. Parking: _____

Section 2 · Questions 11·20

Answer the questions below. Write NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER, or choose the correct letter.

11. The reserve opened in _____.

12. The main habitat is a _____.

13. Visitors must stay on _____.

14. What is the rule about dogs?
    A They may run on the mud.
    B They must be kept on a lead.
    C They are not allowed in.

15. The best month for migrating birds is _____.

16. The hide closes at _____.

17. The family trail is _____ long.

18. Volunteers meet at _____.

19. What should you do if you see a seal?
    A Offer it fish.
    B Take a close photograph.
    C Do not approach it.

20. The donation box is _____.

Section 3 · Questions 21·30

Choose the correct letter, or write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

21. What does Maya want the project to focus on?
    A Park hives.
    B Rooftop hives.
    C A laboratory colony.

22. What is Maya worried about?
    A The sample size.
    B The meeting day.
    C The library hours.

23. They will count bees for _____.

24. Chris suggests using _____.

25. What does the tutor prefer?
    A Pan traps.
    B Interviews.
    C Photographs.

26. The library database is called _____.

27. They will meet on _____.

28. The draft is due on _____.

29. What do they disagree about?
    A The deadline.
    B Interviewing beekeepers.
    C The meeting day.

30. Their next step is to _____.

Section 4 · Questions 31·40

Complete the notes. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer. The lecture describes a fictional harbour.

31. The entrance was dangerous because of a _____.

32. The first warning used hand _____.

33. When did the bells fail?
    A When the wind came from the east.
    B When the museum opened.
    C In winter only.

34. The 1872 experiment used a steam _____.

35. The whistle could be heard for _____.

36. What did residents complain about?
    A Broken sleep.
    B The museum fee.
    C The sandbar.

37. In 1904 the replacement was a reed _____.

38. The horn was powered by _____.

39. What signal is used today?
    A A steam whistle.
    B A radio beacon.
    C Hand bells.

40. The old horn is now in the maritime _____.

Reading

Reading Passage 1 · Why the Greyhaven Marshes Were Given Back to the Tide

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1·13.

For most of the twentieth century the marshes east of Greyhaven were treated as land that had not yet been improved. A sea wall, finished in 1926, held the tide out so that sheep could graze. Only later did a small airfield use the drained fields to store fuel. The wall did what it was built to do, but the ground behind it sank. Drained peat shrinks, and by the 1990s winter rain sat on the fields for weeks.

In 2004 the harbour board stopped repairing a breach that had opened to 400 metres, and let the water return. The decision was practical rather than romantic. Engineers calculated that raising the wall would cost more than the farmland was worth, and the town needed a place for storm water to spread. What followed surprised even the people who had argued for the change. Within three summers, glasswort and sea lavender covered the mud, and redshank nested on the higher tussocks. During the 2013 surge the breach lowered the peak flood level in Greyhaven's lower streets by a measured 18 centimetres.

Farmers who lost grazing were offered hay from inland meadows for five years, plus a payment tied to the number of breeding waders on their remaining fields. Not every family accepted. Two families took the board to court and lost. The hearing did force the board to publish its flood model, which it still updates every March.

Visitors are kept to a single boardwalk. Unofficial paths broke the salt crust and left shallow pools where mosquitoes bred, so those paths were closed. Guides say the richest hour is the last hour before dusk, when the wind drops and birds feed on the falling tide. The marshes are not a park. There is no cafe, and the hide has no glass, only a slot at sitting height. Anyone who wants a view of the whole estuary walks up to the old fuel shed, which has been left standing as a marker and nothing more.

Questions 1·7

Do the following statements agree with the passage? Write TRUE, FALSE, or NOT GIVEN.

1. The sea wall was built in order to create an airfield.

2. The ground behind the wall became lower over time.

3. The board let the tide return because residents demanded a nature reserve.

4. Glasswort and sea lavender appeared within three summers.

5. The 2013 surge was the highest on record for Greyhaven.

6. Compensation for farmers depended partly on breeding waders.

7. All of the affected families accepted the payment.

Questions 8·13

Answer the questions. Write NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER from the passage.

8. In which year did the board stop repairing the breach?

9. How wide was the breach when repairs stopped?

10. By how much did the peak flood level fall in the lower streets?

11. How often is the flood model updated?

12. Unofficial paths left pools where _____ bred.

13. The old fuel shed now stands as _____.

Reading Passage 2 · How Greyhaven Cools Its Streets

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 14·26.

A Greyhaven did not start with a master plan for heat. In 2016 a run of nights above 24 degrees made the upstairs rooms of the market streets unusable, and the council simply counted which blocks stayed hottest after sunset. The count, published as the Warm Block List, has been repeated every July since.

B The first works were dull and effective. Dark asphalt on Lime Walk was replaced with a pale stone that reflects more sunlight, and bus shelters gained roofs deep enough to shade the queue. These changes were cheap, and they did not require anyone to move.

C Trees came next, but not as decoration. The council plants only species that can live with salt wind, and it waters them from a tank under the town hall for the first two summers. After that the trees are expected to cope. A survey in 2022 found that a mature tree outside the post office dropped the pavement temperature by 7 degrees at midday.

D Shops were harder to persuade. A grant pays for canvas awnings, yet the grant is refused if the awning carries advertising. The point, the council says, is shade, not a billboard. About sixty shops had joined by 2024.

E Water is used sparingly. A misting pipe runs along the fish market for two hours at lunchtime in July and August, and is switched off when the wind rises above 20 kilometres an hour, because the mist then blows into doorways. Fountains were discussed and rejected: they waste water and the drains are already tired.

F Residents still argue about one proposal: closing the market to cars at noon. Traders say deliveries would suffer. The council has trialled the closure on three Thursdays, and the temperature data from those days has not yet been published. Until it is, the Warm Block List remains a record of streets, not a verdict on traffic.

Questions 14·19

The passage has six paragraphs, A·F. Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list. There are more headings than paragraphs.

14. Paragraph A

i A list that is updated each summer
ii Why fountains were turned down
iii Cheap changes to surfaces and shelters
iv A grant with a strict rule
v Trees chosen for a coastal town
vi Opposition from the railway
vii An unfinished argument about cars
viii Painting the roofs white

15. Paragraph B
    i A list that is updated each summer
    ii Why fountains were turned down
    iii Cheap changes to surfaces and shelters
    iv A grant with a strict rule
    v Trees chosen for a coastal town
    vi Opposition from the railway
    vii An unfinished argument about cars
    viii Painting the roofs white

16. Paragraph C
    i A list that is updated each summer
    ii Why fountains were turned down
    iii Cheap changes to surfaces and shelters
    iv A grant with a strict rule
    v Trees chosen for a coastal town
    vi Opposition from the railway
    vii An unfinished argument about cars
    viii Painting the roofs white

17. Paragraph D
    i A list that is updated each summer
    ii Why fountains were turned down
    iii Cheap changes to surfaces and shelters
    iv A grant with a strict rule
    v Trees chosen for a coastal town
    vi Opposition from the railway
    vii An unfinished argument about cars
    viii Painting the roofs white

18. Paragraph E
    i A list that is updated each summer
    ii Why fountains were turned down
    iii Cheap changes to surfaces and shelters
    iv A grant with a strict rule
    v Trees chosen for a coastal town
    vi Opposition from the railway
    vii An unfinished argument about cars
    viii Painting the roofs white

19. Paragraph F
    i A list that is updated each summer
    ii Why fountains were turned down
    iii Cheap changes to surfaces and shelters
    iv A grant with a strict rule
    v Trees chosen for a coastal town
    vi Opposition from the railway
    vii An unfinished argument about cars
    viii Painting the roofs white

Questions 20·23

Choose the correct letter, A, B, or C.

20. The Warm Block List was first based on
    A night-time heat in particular blocks.
    B hospital admissions during heat.
    C sales figures from the market.

21. The pale stone on Lime Walk was chosen because it
    A was quarried in the town.
    B reflects more sunlight.
    C needs no cleaning.

22. The misting pipe is switched off when
    A lunchtime ends.
    B the wind is too strong.
    C shopkeepers complain.

23. The Thursday car closures
    A are now permanent.
    B were cancelled after one week.
    C have not had their temperature data published.

Questions 24·26

Write NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER from the passage.

24. The tree outside the post office cooled the pavement by _____.

25. About _____ shops had joined the awning grant by 2024.

26. Young trees are watered from a tank under _____.

Reading Passage 3 · The Lark Foundry

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 27·40.

The Lark Foundry, in a shed beside Greyhaven harbour, still cuts type for small presses. The metal it pours is brass, not the lead mix used by the big city houses. Brass costs more, but it holds a hairline and does not soften in a warm studio. A single alphabet, from the comma to the capital, takes about six weeks if the work is not interrupted.

The drawing of each letter begins in candle smoke. A designer holds a card above the flame until a black film forms, then scratches the shape out of that film with a needle. The method sounds antique, and it is, but the smoke shows a shaky curve more honestly than a bright screen. Only after the scratch is agreed does anyone open the computer file.

Apprentices do not design in their first year. They sweep brass dust, learn the names of the tools, and spend Friday mornings at a window that faces the harbour, copying the same lowercase n until the joins are even. The foundry takes two apprentices a year and keeps a chair for a retired cutter who still comes on Thursday to argue about spacing.

Orders leave by van, not by the river. The river door is kept for the tide, which floods the lower step a few times each winter. Customers who want a faster alphabet are told to go elsewhere. The foundry's view is that a hurried letter is a letter the press will regret, and the waiting list is part of the price.

Questions 27·33

Complete the summary. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER from the passage.

27. The foundry pours type from _____.

28. One alphabet takes about _____ if the work is not interrupted.

29. Letters are first scratched out of _____.

30. A shaky curve is easier to see in the smoke than on a bright _____.

31. In the first year, _____ do not design letters.

32. A retired cutter still comes on _____.

33. Finished orders leave by _____.

Questions 34·37

Choose the correct letter, A, B, or C.

34. Why does the foundry prefer brass to a lead mix?
    A It is cheaper.
    B It holds a hairline and does not soften in warmth.
    C It can be sent by river.

35. The computer file is opened
    A before the letter is drawn.
    B only after the scratched shape is agreed.
    C by the apprentices on Fridays.

36. What do first-year apprentices do on Friday mornings?
    A They design a new alphabet.
    B They copy a lowercase n by the window.
    C They deliver orders.

37. Customers who want a faster alphabet are
    A offered a discount.
    B told to go elsewhere.
    C asked to collect it by boat.

Questions 38·40

Write TRUE, FALSE, or NOT GIVEN.

38. The foundry takes two apprentices a year.

39. The river door is used for deliveries.

40. The retired cutter was once the owner of the foundry.

Writing

Task 1

Write at least 150 words.

The chart below shows visits to three libraries in one city in 2019, 2021, and 2024. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Visits, in thousands.

2019 2021 2024

North: 40 55 62 thousand visits

Market: 70 48 36 thousand visits

Harbour: 22 30 58 thousand visits

Task 2

Write at least 250 words.

Some people believe that private cars should be banned from city centres. Others think drivers need access to those streets. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.